

[Table 53.9](#) shows how busted patterns performed. Samples are few for all categories. With few samples, the results are likely to change.

Busted patterns count. I found most of the busted patterns after a downward breakout, so let's talk about those.

A busted roof occurs when the breakout is downward (in this example) and price drops no more than 10%. Price reverses and closes above the *top of the pattern*, busting the downward breakout.

[Table 53.9](#) Busted Patterns

Description	Up Breakout	Down Breakout
Busted patterns count	45 or 32%	74 or 39%
Single bust count	22 or 49%	52 or 70%
Double bust count	15 or 33%	4 or 5%
Triple+ bust count	8 or 18%	18 or 24%
Performance for all busted patterns	–15%	36%
Single busted performance	–25%	49%
Non-busted performance	–15%	34%

I found 39% of the patterns I looked at busted in this manner (or went on to double or triple bust).

Upward breakouts can bust, too, when price breaks out upward, reverses before rising too far, and closes below the bottom of the roof. The busting can continue for both breakout directions if the move is less than 10% before price reverses and trends to the other end of the roof. I stopped counting at three busts (which I call triple+, for three or more busts).

Busted occurrence. Most of the busted patterns were single busts (70%), followed by triple+ busts (24%). The Glossary gives details on single, double, and triple+ busts, so check there if you're confused.

Busted and non-busted performance. Comparing the performance of all busted patterns (no matter how many busts occurred) with single busts, we find that single busted patterns outperformed in all cases, which is typical for chart patterns.